



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Iraq. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing a bit about yourself — that's really helpful context. You're at an exciting point in life with many good options ahead of you. Since you're in Denmark, just finished primary school (**folkeskolen**), and are 16 years old, you're now eligible for youth education (ungdomsuddannelse), which includes several main paths depending on your interests, strengths, and career goals.

Here's a breakdown of your main options and when they might be a good fit:

1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (Upper Secondary Education)

These are for students who want to go to university later. They're academic and take 3 years.

- **STX (Almen studentereksamen)** – Broad focus with science, language, social studies, and arts. Good if you're not sure yet.
- **HHX (Højere handelseksamen)** – Focus on business, economics, marketing. Great if you're interested in business or entrepreneurship.
- **HTX (Højere teknisk eksamen)** – Focus on science, technology, IT, and math. Good for future engineers or tech careers.
- **HF (Højere forberedelseksamen)** – Shorter (2 years) and more practical. Often for those who didn't go directly from 9th grade to gymnasium or want a faster route to professions.

● Recommended if:

- You enjoy academic subjects
- You want to keep your university options open
- You're still exploring what you want to do

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (VET – Vocational Education and Training)

These combine school and practical training (apprenticeship) in a workplace. They usually take 3-4 years.

Examples:

- Electrician, mechanic, carpenter
- Hairdresser, chef
- Social- and health care assistant
- IT supporter, data technician

● Recommended if:

- You like hands-on work and learning by doing
- You want to start working and earning earlier
- You have a specific profession in mind

💡 *Bonus:* Some VET programs now allow you to continue to university afterwards if you take the EUX program (a mix of vocational and academic).

3. EUX (Hybrid program – VET + Gymnasium level)

This lets you get a vocational education **and** a general upper secondary diploma.

🟢 Recommended if:

- You want to work in a trade but also keep the door open to university later
- You're motivated and can handle a more intense study program

How to Choose?

Think about:

- **What are you good at and what do you enjoy?** (Science, helping others, working with your hands, technology, etc.)
- **Do you want to go to university later, or start working sooner?**
- **Do you prefer school/classroom learning or more practical experience?**

Example Pathways

If you like...	You could choose...
Business & economy	HHX or VET in sales or administration
Tech, engineering	HTX or VET in IT, electrician, data technician
Working with people	HF or VET in healthcare, social worker
Crafts or practical work	VET (carpenter, mechanic, chef, etc.)
Not sure yet	STX or HF to explore broadly

What I'd Recommend (based on what you shared):

Since you're fluent in Danish, born and raised here, and just finished school, you likely qualify for **all** these paths. If you're not sure yet what career you want, I'd suggest **STX** or **HHX** – they keep many doors open, help build strong academic and personal skills, and give you more time to figure out what you enjoy.

But if you already have a strong interest (like tech, health, or trades), a **VET** or **EUX** program could be a faster and more practical route.

If you'd like, tell me more about:

- What subjects you liked most in school?
- What kind of work or lifestyle you imagine for your future?
- Whether you're more interested in university or starting work earlier?

Then I can give more tailored advice.